



*Let the mind manage the body
Que l'esprit gère le corps*

**MAURITIUS
EXAMINATIONS
SYNDICATE**

**PSAC 2025
Modern Chinese (P200)**

EXAMINERS' REPORT

INTRODUCTION

The 2025 Modern Chinese Primary School Achievement Certificate (PSAC) question paper was based on the Teaching and Learning Syllabus of Modern Chinese.

The NCE assessment in Modern Chinese assessment focuses on the following areas:

1. Reading Comprehension (40%)
2. Writing (30%)
3. Grammar and Vocabulary (30%)

These assessment objectives are consistent with the National Curriculum Framework (NCF) for Primary Education. A variety of competency-based tasks, set at different levels of difficulty, were included to promote greater fairness. This differentiated assessment approach enables students of all ability levels to demonstrate their skills and knowledge effectively.

General Comments

A total of 160 candidates sat for the assessment, of whom 119 obtained a passing grade. Nevertheless, 25.6% of the candidates did not meet the minimum pass requirements, indicating a notable area that requires improvement.

To address this gap, educators are encouraged to:

- Conduct a detailed analysis of the factors contributing to underperformance (e.g., curriculum alignment, teaching strategies, or student engagement).
- Implement targeted interventions, such as differentiated instruction or remedial support, to improve learning outcomes.

Proactive actions in these areas will help promote equitable progress and strengthen proficiency in Modern Chinese among future cohorts.

Specific Comments

Question 1A

The purpose of this question is to assess candidates' knowledge of common vocabulary. It relates to the labelling of 5 pictures and carries a total of 5 marks. Most candidates performed poorly in this exercise. Many candidates were unable to write “船”, “雨伞”, “老鼠” and “门”. Many candidates gave “东西” as their answer, which is considered too vague; therefore, no marks were awarded. Some candidates wrote their answers in English, which is unacceptable, while others provided only Chinese Pinyin or wrote only part of the word, for example “动”.

Question 1B

The purpose of this question is to assess candidates' basic reading comprehension skills. It requires candidates to match each sentence with the corresponding picture. The question carries 5 marks. Many candidates performed very well in this section.

Question 2A

A range of grammatical structures were tested through multiple-choice items in this question. This year, the use of interrogative pronouns (疑问代词), measure words (量词), personal pronouns (人称代词), adverbs (副词), conjunction (连词), measure word reduplication (量词重叠), complement of result (结果补语) and noun of locality (方位词) amongst others were assessed. Most candidates scored below 5 marks. The poor performance in this question revealed pupils' poor knowledge of Chinese grammar. It consists of 10 multiple choice questions which carry 1 mark each.

The following items were found challenging:

Item 2: 她家门口有一棵芒果树。

Many candidates incorrectly answered with “只” (measure word for boats, birds, certain animals, certain containers, and one of a pair) or “件” (measure word for clothing, furniture, luggage) instead of “棵” (measure word for trees, cabbages plants, etc.). Students may have overgeneralized “只/件” because it is a very common measure word for animals and piece/item respectively, so they use it when they are unsure.

Item 4: 中文书贵，可是英文书更贵。

Many candidates incorrectly selected "非常" or even "很" instead of the correct answer.

"更", where "更" is used for comparison.

The sentence contains a comparison between two things:

中文书贵 – Chinese books are expensive.

英文书 更 贵 – English books are more expensive.

So, the structure is:

A + adjective, 可是/但是 + B + 更 + adjective

“很” means very, but it does not show comparison. “非常” means extremely/very, expressing degree, not comparison.

Item 5: 妹妹不但会唱歌，而且会跳舞。

Many candidates answered with “虽然”，“如果”，or “就”，all of which are incorrect.

In Chinese grammar, “不但……而且……” is a paired conjunction structure used to add information. Meaning: not only ... but also ...

Structure: 不但 + clause 1 , 而且 + clause 2

“虽然” means although / even though and expresses contrast, not addition.

“如果” means if, introducing a condition.

“就” usually appears in conditional or sequential structures.

The candidates struggled with this question mainly because:

- They confused different conjunction pairs.
- They memorised individual words instead of full sentence patterns.
- Their native languages do not rely on strict paired connectors like Chinese.

Item 6: 我家的小狗只只都很可爱。

Many candidates did not provide the correct answer and instead gave responses such as “幅幅”，“双双”and “张张”.

This suggests that some candidates have not yet fully mastered the use of Chinese measure words (量词). The measure word “只” is commonly used for animals such as dogs, and in

this sentence “只只” emphasises that every dog is very cute. The incorrect answers indicate that some candidates selected measure words they were familiar with without considering whether they were appropriate for the noun “小狗”.

This error may also reflect the influence of English and French, where such classifier systems are very limited. Teachers should therefore place greater emphasis on helping learners understand the correct pairing of nouns and measure words.

Item 7: 我看到李老师在路上跑步。

Many candidates gave incorrect answers such as “吃到”, “喝到”, and “扔到” instead of the correct “看到” (to see). This suggests that some students did not fully understand the meaning of “看到” or the context of the sentence.

A common reason is that candidates focused on the shared “到” and chose familiar verbs like “吃” and “喝”, without checking if the meaning made sense. They may also have ignored the context, which clearly requires a perception verb because the speaker is observing someone running on the road. Teachers should encourage students to pay attention to the sentence context and choose verbs that fit the situation.

Item 8: 坐火车比坐飞机慢。

Many candidates incorrectly answered with “同”, “跟”, or “和”, which are inappropriate in this context. One main reason for this error appears to be a misunderstanding of the sentence structure. Some candidates did not recognise “比” as the comparative marker and instead interpreted the sentence as “坐火车和坐飞机慢。” (Travelling by train and travelling by plane are slow), treating it as a simple conjunction rather than a comparison.

Another possible reason is confusion with commonly used connecting words. “同”, “跟”, and “和” are high-frequency vocabulary items that students encounter early in their Chinese learning, whereas “比” introduces a specific comparative structure. When uncertain, candidates may therefore default to these more familiar words.

Teachers are encouraged to reinforce the use of “比” in comparative sentences and provide more practice with common comparison structures.

Item 10: 学校运动会一直到下午两点才结束。

Many candidates answered incorrectly, choosing “因为……所以……” or “从……到……” instead of “一直……才……”.

This error likely occurred because candidates did not fully understand that “一直……才……” expresses that an action continued up to a certain point before happening. They may have defaulted to more familiar patterns like “从……到……” or “因为……所以……”, which do not fit the context. Mauritian candidates may benefit from extra practice with temporal structures like “一直……才……”.

Question 2B

For Question 2B, candidates were tested on vocabulary in context through multiple-choice items. The section consisted of 5 questions, each worth 1 mark.

The following items were found challenging:

Item 1: 林雪静穿新裙子去参加婚礼。

Many candidates selected “听” or “吃” instead of the correct answer “穿”. This suggests a lack of contextual understanding. Candidates may have focused on familiar verbs without considering the action associated with wearing a new dress to attend a wedding.

Item 3: 小鸟在树上做窝。

Very few candidates answered correctly. Many chose “海” or “河” rather than “树”. This indicates difficulty in connecting the sentence context with the correct noun. Candidates may not have associated birds and nest with tree and instead selected familiar nouns related to natural settings they know, such as “sea” or “river.”

Item 5: 做饭的时候，妈妈用刀子切菜。

Many students chose “汤匙”, “盘子”, or “杯子” instead of “刀子”. This suggests that they chose more familiar kitchen items rather than considering the action described. The choice of the correct utensil requires understanding both the action (切菜 – cutting vegetables) and the appropriate tool (刀子 – knife), which some candidates overlooked.

Candidates tended to rely on familiar vocabulary items rather than carefully analysing sentence context. This indicates a need for further practice in linking verbs and nouns with their situational context to improve accuracy in vocabulary-in-context questions.

Question 3

Question 3 assessed candidates' ability to read and understand an informative text, as well as to locate explicit information. Overall, candidates performed satisfactorily.

The text was a poster announcing the opening of a new shop at Royal Road, Port Louis. The shop, called Students' Shop, operates from Monday to Friday, 9:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., and on weekends from 10:00 a.m. to 9:00 p.m. Customers can purchase clothes, shoes, and watches. Children will receive bags, copybooks, and toys as gifts, and customers spending Rs 1,000 or more will receive an entrance ticket to Casela. The poster invited everyone to visit the shop and provided a contact for further information: Anna 57909868.

The following items were found challenging for the candidates.

Item 3: 新开的商店叫什么名字?

Expected answer: 学生商店。

Common error: Many candidates wrote incomplete responses ("学生" or "商店"), resulting in lost marks.

Item 4: 星期五, 新开的商店几点开门?

Expected answer: 上午九点半。/早上九点半。

Many candidates wrongly provided “上午九点半到下午五点。” as answer. It seems that the students did not understand the meaning of “几点开门”.

Item 5: 星期日, 新开的商店几点关门?

Expected answer: 晚上九点。

Some candidates provided answers such as “上午十点到晚上九点。”. This answer is definitely incorrect as they gave too much information, meaning the candidates did not understand the exact required information. The candidates should be encouraged to read both the text and questions more carefully to identify the required details.

Item 6: 写出可以在商店里买到的两个东西。

Expected answers: Any two from the following: “衣服”、“鞋子” and “手表”.

Some candidates also provided “书包、本子和玩具” as answers, which are all incorrect.

This suggests candidates need to pay closer attention to the question.

Item 8: 买了 1000 卢比以上的东西的人会得到什么？

Expected answer: 一张去鸟园的门票。

Some candidates provided partial answers like “票” or “门票”. While these contain elements of the correct answer, they are incomplete. The candidates should be reminded to provide full, precise answers that match the question requirements.

Item 9: 要怎样才能知道商店的更多信息？

Expected answer: 跟安娜联系，电话号码是：57909868。

Many candidates provided answers such as “安娜”，“跟安娜联系”，“电话号码是：57909868”，or simply “57909868”. However, these responses are incomplete, as they do not include both the contact person and the phone number. Therefore, marks were not awarded.

Question 4

Question 4 was split into two parts: **4A** and **4B**.

This type of comprehension passage is more challenging than that of Question 3, as it assesses candidates' higher-order reading skills. Their ability was evaluated based on their understanding of an extended narrative centred on a simple everyday incident and the lesson learned from it. The story unfolds as follows:

The story tells about an afternoon when Li Yun and her younger brother Li Liang go to a nearby playground to fly a kite, accompanied by their little dog. The weather is perfect, and Li Liang is especially happy because the kite is a birthday gift from his uncle. However, while flying it, a strong gust of wind snaps the string, and the kite gets stuck high up in a tree.

Li Liang becomes very upset, and although Li Yun tries to help by climbing the tree, it is too tall. Just as they feel sad and helpless, an old man passing by offers assistance. With the help of the old man's long stick, Li Liang is able to bring the kite down safely. In the end, the

children thank the old man and learn an important lesson about being more careful, returning home happily with their dog.

Performance Breakdown:

Only a small number of candidates achieved full marks in Questions 4A and 4B. Very few demonstrated an excellent understanding of the passage, managing to earn full marks in Question 4. As expected, weaker candidates found it challenging to read for meaning, which led to lower scores.

Question 4A

Question 4A assesses candidates' ability to locate explicit information in the comprehension passage through five multiple-choice questions, each carrying 1 mark. Challenge: Many candidates had difficulty to fully understand the questions, which prevented them from obtaining full marks.

The following items were found challenging:

Item 2 李云和李亮去操场上放风筝。

Many candidates selected “邻居家” or “他们的院子里” incorrectly, indicating a lack of comprehension. These choices suggest that some candidates relied on word familiarity rather than understanding the context, leading to errors.

Item 3 风筝掉到树上是因为线断了。

For this question, many candidates answered incorrectly, indicating a gap in their comprehension of the passage, as the answer is not directly stated in the passage and requires comprehension of the sequence of events and the underlying cause-and-effect relationships. Although the other options do not appear in the relevant paragraph, candidates still needed to infer the correct response from the context. This shows that selecting the right answer required careful reading and a genuine understanding of the text.

Item 5 李亮用一根很长的木棒捅风筝，风筝掉到了地上。

Few candidates selected the correct answer. Many were misled by the shared measure word “一根” in options B and C, choosing “C. 一根树枝” instead. A small number selected “A. 一条线” or “B. 一只山羊”, likely by guessing. This indicates that some candidates struggled to identify the key detail in the passage.

Question 4B

Question 4B assesses candidates’ higher-order reading comprehension skills, going beyond literal understanding to evaluate a range of interpretive abilities. The candidates were tested on:

- Identifying central themes and key ideas.
- Inferring the meanings of unfamiliar vocabulary.
- Locating explicit information.
- Formulating personal responses to the text.

The following items were found challenging for the candidates.

Item 3 风筝掉到了树上的时候，李亮感觉怎么样？

The expected answer was: 很难过。/哭了起来。

Many candidates either left this question unanswered or answered by “突然，一阵大风吹来，风筝的线断了。” We believe the errors occurred because:

- They overlooked the key word “感觉” in the question.
- They did not understand the question.

Item 4 为了找回风筝，李云是怎么做的？

The expected answer was: 李云想爬到树上。

It has been noted that some candidates answered with:

李云想爬到树上，但是树太高了，她爬不上去。

While this sentence contains the expected answer, it includes extra information that goes beyond what is being asked. This indicates lifting, where candidates provide more context than required, possibly because they are unsure which part of the story is being targeted.

Extra details about the tree being too high should not affect correctness, but remind students to provide concise answers that directly address the question.

Other candidates answered wrongly by providing the following as answers:

树太高了，她爬不上去。

To avoid such error, remind students that they should pay close attention to the question phrasing (e.g., “为了找回风筝，李云是怎么做的？”), which requires a direct answer.

Item 5 当老人看到李云和李亮的时候，老人在做什么？

Expected Answer:

老人牵着一只山羊走过来。/老人正走过来。

Although the question is straightforward, many candidates gave incomplete answers such as “一只山羊走过来” or “老人牵着一只山羊,” omitting the subject’s action. This indicates they did not fully comprehend the question or failed to include all key information.

Item 6 当李亮找回了风筝的时候，他的感觉怎么样？

Expected Answer:

李亮很高兴。/李亮很开心。/李亮感到很高兴。

Many candidates provided “非常感谢您！/非常谢谢您！” as answer. This indicates that the candidates missed the core meaning of the question which is how Li Liang felt after he retrieved his kite.

Some candidates answered “非常感谢您！” or “非常谢谢您！,” showing they focused on polite expressions rather than Li Liang’s emotions. This indicates they missed the core point of the question, which is how he felt after retrieving his kite.

General recommendations for improving candidate’s responses:

1. Emphasise reading comprehension.

Encourage candidates to focus on the specific question being asked. For example, Item 5 asks what the old man was doing, not just what was present.

2. Practice identifying key information.

Train students to underline or highlight subjects, actions and emotions in questions. This can help to avoid incomplete answers like “一只山羊走过来” or “非常感谢您！”.

3. Model complete answers.

Provide examples of full responses that include both subject and action (Item 5) or subject and emotion (Item 6).

4. Use Question-Answer drills.

Give short passages with simple questions and ask candidates to answer in complete sentences, emphasising the action or feeling.

5. Feedback on common mistakes.

Show examples of incorrect answers and explain why they are incomplete or off-target. This helps candidates internalise what the question truly asks.

6. Encourage emotion vocabulary practice.

Provide lists of words for feelings and emotions (高兴, 开心, 伤心, 生气, 紧张) and practice matching them to scenarios.

Item 7 按照故事情节的发展排列顺序。

1. 风筝在天上飞。1

2. 李云和李亮感谢老人。4

3. 李亮用木棒捅风筝，风筝掉到了地上。3

4. 风筝掉到了树上。2

The sentences should be rearranged in the following order:

风筝在天上飞。

风筝掉到了树上。

李亮用木棒捅风筝，风筝掉到了地上。

李云和李亮感谢老人。

The candidates gave the following chronological order as answer:

1. 风筝在天上飞。 1
2. 李云和李亮感谢老人。 4
3. 李亮用木棒捅风筝，风筝掉到了地上。 2
4. 风筝掉到了树上。 3

It appears that candidates confused sentences 3 (“李亮用木棒捅风筝，风筝掉到了地上。”) and 2 (“风筝掉到了树上。”) because the phrases are very similar. This likely caused incorrect numbering.

Recommendations for improving performance

1. Read carefully.

Encourage students to read attentively and highlight differences, especially in sentences with similar phrasing.

2. Distinguish plot from perspective.

Provide explicit instructions on identifying plot events vs. character reactions or perspectives.

3. Practice narrative skills.

Implement exercises that train students to:

- Identify key turning points in a story.
- Support answers with direct textual evidence.

4. Offer practice with questions requiring:

- Cause-effect analysis
- Character intention interpretation

Question 5

Question 5 comprises two parts: **5A** and **5B**.

Questions 5A and 5B assessed candidates' knowledge of grammar in writing at sentence level.

Question 5A

This question evaluated candidates' ability to:

- Apply syntactic knowledge.
- Rearrange jumbled words into grammatically correct sentences.

- Demonstrate sentence-level writing proficiency.

Scoring system:

- Full marks (2 points) per item: Only awarded for completely correct answers.
- Partial answers: Received no marks.
- This strict grading emphasized precision in sentence construction.

To enhance student performance, the teachers could:

1. Incorporate regular jumbled-sentence exercises
2. Focus on developing:
 - Word-order recognition
 - Grammatical pattern identification
3. Provide targeted practice in:
 - Sentence structure analysis
 - Syntax application

(一) 学好、要、汉语、你们

The expected answer was: 你们要学好汉语。

Some candidates provided the response: 汉语你们要学好。

While this structure is grammatically possible for emphasis, it does not reflect the standard neutral word order expected in this question.

Other incorrect responses included:

要你们学好汉语。

要你们汉语学好。

These errors indicate confusion in the use and placement of “要” as a modal verb, as well as difficulties with the complement of result “学好”.

The teachers are advised to put greater emphasis on the correct positioning of modal verbs such as “要”, and the use of complements of result (e.g., “学好”). This can be reinforced through varied sentence patterns and contextualised examples in classroom teaching.

(二) 莎莎、雨衣、丢了、蓝色的、一件

The expected answer was: 莎莎丢了一件蓝色的雨衣。

This question assessed candidates' understanding of sentence structure involving the particle “了” and numeral-measure word phrases. Specifically, the structure requires that “动词+了” precede the numeral-measure word phrase.

The item proved challenging for many candidates, as shown by the following incorrect responses:

一件蓝色的雨衣莎莎丢了。(Incorrect subject–object order)

莎莎丢了蓝色的雨衣一件。(Incorrect placement of the numeral-measure word phrase)

These responses suggest that candidates have not fully mastered the correct word order in sentences combining “了” with quantified objects. The teachers are therefore encouraged to reinforce the standard word order in such sentence structures, and the correct positioning of numeral-measure word phrases through targeted practice and explicit explanation.

The prevalent incorrect answers appear to stem primarily from cross-linguistic interference, with particular influence from:

1. Creole syntactic structures
2. French grammatical patterns
3. English sentence formation

The teachers are advised to provide to the students more examples and additional practice opportunities.

Question 5B

Regarding Question 5B, candidates were required to complete a set of given sentences. This question assessed their ability to construct grammatically correct sentences and demonstrated their understanding of syntax at sentence level. It carried a total of 6 marks. However, many candidates were unable to obtain full marks. To improve performance, teachers are advised to provide more practice exercises of this type in class.

Item 1 assessed whether candidates could understand and appropriately complete the phrase “每天早上我们……” (“Every morning we...”), which was provided as the beginning of the sentence.

Some responses given by candidates included:

每天早上我们在吃水果。

每天早上我们在看电视。

每天早上我们是很高兴。

每天早上我们去了学校。

每天早上我们吃车上。

These responses indicate that some candidates experienced difficulties with correct grammatical structures, appropriate verb usage, or forming meaningful sentences in context.

Examples of good responses include:

每天早上我们浇水。

每天早上我们吃早饭。

每天早上我们看书。

每天早上我们一起去学校。

每天早上我们都吃面包。

These answers demonstrate a clear understanding of the prompt, appropriate vocabulary usage, and correct sentence structure.

Item 2 assessed whether candidates could understand and appropriately complete the phrase “妈妈到超市……” (“Mother goes to the supermarket...”).

Some candidates did not fully grasp the meaning of the given phrase, resulting in responses that were either incomplete, grammatically inaccurate, or contextually inappropriate.

Examples of such responses include:

妈妈到超市看电视。

妈妈到超市头发。

妈妈到超市买吃饭。

妈妈到超市喝水。

Although some of these responses are grammatically acceptable at a basic level, they are unnatural or illogical within the given context.

Examples of good responses include:

妈妈到超市买东西。

妈妈到超市买水果。

妈妈到超市买很多水果。

妈妈到超市买菜。

These responses demonstrate an appropriate understanding of the prompt, as well as correct and meaningful use of vocabulary and sentence structure.

Item 3 assessed whether candidates could understand and appropriately complete the phrase “今天的天气……” (“Today’s weather...”).

Many candidates produced incomplete or incorrect responses, indicating difficulties in forming meaningful and grammatically appropriate sentences based on the given prompt.

Examples of such responses include:

今天的天气我们在看电视。

今天的天气我们看电视。

今天的天气莎莎风筝。

今天的天气我去海边。

今天的天气去学校。

These responses show that some candidates did not recognise that the prompt requires a description of the weather, and instead produced unrelated or structurally incorrect sentences. Examples of good responses include:

今天的天气很好。

今天的天气很冷。

These answers demonstrate a clear understanding of the prompt, with appropriate vocabulary and correct sentence structure.

Question 6

The cloze test is a higher-order reading task designed to assess candidates’ ability to use context to select appropriate words, thereby evaluating their reading comprehension and language application skills. Candidates were required to complete a passage by filling in blanks with suitable words from a given list. This question carried 10 marks.

This year’s passage described a student who was sick and visited a doctor, highlighting interactions with parents and medical advice.

昨天我没有去学校，因为我病了。我的父母带我去医院看病。医生是一个很好的人，他给我做了检查，他说我发烧了，他给了我一些药吃，告诉我要多喝水。医生

还建议我要多吃青菜和水果。三十分钟以后，我觉得好多了，烧退了。医生就让我跟我的父母一起回家。

Many candidates lost marks due to difficulty in correctly completing the blanks with the expected words: '父母' (parents), '说' (to say), '建议' (to suggest/advise), '以后' (after), and '回' (to go back). The errors suggest that candidates faced challenges in accurately interpreting contextual cues and applying vocabulary appropriately.

Question 7A

This question evaluated candidates' ability to identify and correct errors in Chinese characters within context. Candidates were presented with five short sentences containing character mistakes and were required to provide the correct forms. The item carried 5 marks; however, only a small number of candidates achieved full marks. The main difficulties observed included challenges in accurately writing Chinese characters and selecting the contextually appropriate vocabulary.

Most challenging items:

Item 3: 太 (太) 阳出来了。

Some candidates failed to recognise "太阳" (the sun), particularly struggling with the character "太".

Item 4: 爸爸是一立 (位) 汉语老师。

Several candidates substituted "个" (a general measure word) instead of the expected "位", resulting in loss of marks.

Item 5: 明天我们学校没有 (不) 举行运动会。

Candidates frequently demonstrated confusion between the negation words "不" and "没", particularly in this future context.

Question 7B

This question assessed candidates' ability to write the correct Chinese characters based on the provided Chinese Pinyin within given contextual sentences. The question was worth 5 marks.

Most challenging items:

Item 1 暑假你去哪儿玩 (wán) 了?

Many candidates failed to write the correct character “玩”, with some incorrectly substituting “完” or “晚”. This indicates difficulty in distinguishing homophones in context.

Item 4 他每天都坐公共汽车上 (shàng) 学。

Although the word “上学” (to go to school) is composed of simple characters, many candidates were unable to identify it in context. They may be more familiar with the alternative expression “去学校” to convey the same meaning.

Item 5 生日那天我拍了很多照片 (piàn) 。

Many candidates were unable to recall the word “照片” (photograph), leading to a significant number of unanswered responses.

Question 8

This question assessed candidates' ability to construct grammatically correct and meaningful sentences based on given pictures and five-word pairs. The question carries 10 marks.

Common issues observed:

- Oversimplified sentences: Some candidates produced very short sentences, often combining only a subject and noun, without using proper grammatical structures.
- Difficulty with specific word pairs: Candidates frequently struggled to incorporate the following pairs appropriately: “突然——摔” (suddenly - fall), “然后——哭” (then - cry), and “一会儿——朋友” (after a while - friend).

- Punctuation errors: Many candidates omitted essential punctuation, such as full stops at sentence endings, which affected clarity and coherence.

Item 1: 一天 —— 玩

This item was quite easy, but still many candidates oversimplified the use of the verb “玩”.

Common attempts included:

一天，我参加玩。Incorrect. “参加” (to participate in) usually needs an event or activity after it (for example, 参加比赛 “participate in a competition”), and “玩” (play) can’t directly follow “参加”.

Correct way: 一天，我去玩。(One day, I went to play.)

一天哥哥玩。Incorrect. Missing a verb or object for clarity. It sounds like “One day brother play,” but in Chinese you need subject + time + verb + object structure.

Correct ways:

一天，哥哥在玩。(One day, elder brother was playing.)

一天，哥哥去玩。(One day, elder brother went to play.)

一天我在玩。Partially correct. This sentence sounds incomplete because “在玩” (am playing) usually implies what you are playing. Improve by using:

一天，我在玩游戏。(One day, I was playing a game.)

Examples of good responses include:

一天，我去玩。

一天，李亮在操场上玩。

一天，弟弟去花园玩。

一天，李小龙在公园里玩。

Item 2: 突然 —— 摔

Candidates struggled to construct meaningful sentences, often adding only minimal context:

突然李小龙摔了。

突然他摔了。

突然他摔到了。Should read as “突然他摔倒了。”

Item 3: 然后 —— 哭

The following responses were obtained:

然后他哭了。Correct and natural, which means “*Then he cried.*”

然后就哭了。Correct and very natural. It means “*Then (he) started crying.*”

然后他哭。Grammatically possible but not natural in most situations. In normal storytelling, you almost always need 了 here.

Item 4: 一会儿 —— 朋友

The following responses were provided by candidates:

一会儿他的朋友来了。Grammatically correct. This was the most common response.

一会儿一个朋友来。Grammatically incomplete. Missing a time/tense marker or sentence-final particle. In Chinese language, you usually need to express like this:

一会儿一个朋友来了。

一会儿，弟弟朋友。Incorrect / incomplete sentence. A verb is missing (no action).

Possible correction: 一会儿弟弟的朋友来了。 (In a while, my younger brother’s friend came.)

Item 5: 最后 —— 回家

The following responses were recorded:

最后，弟弟和朋友回家。Grammatically correct.

最后去回家朋友。Incorrect. Possible correction:

最后去朋友家。 (Finally went to a friend’s house) or 最后和朋友回家。 (Finally went home with a friend)

最后去回家。Incorrect. “去回家” is redundant and ungrammatical. “去” (go) + “回家” (return home) CANNOT be combined. Possible correction: 最后他回家了。 (Finally, he went home)

最后他们一起回家。Grammatically correct. Optional improvement: 最后他们一起回家了。 (Demonstrates completion.)

Question 9

This question evaluates candidates' ability to compose a coherent, continuous passage/text of approximately 100 words based on a given prompt. It assesses higher-order writing skills, including:

- Creative and logical development of a given storyline
- Accurate grammatical expression
- Effective use of varied sentence structures
- Appropriate and rich vocabulary selection

The question carries a total of 10 marks.

The following prompts were given to guide the candidates:

- 一个人去菜市
- 很多人
- 找不到回家的路
- 请人帮忙
- 后来怎么样?

Performance on this question fell below expectations overall. While some candidates demonstrated satisfactory writing ability, the majority struggled significantly. The following sample responses illustrate the range of strengths and weaknesses observed in candidates' work.

Composition 1 (0 mark)

今天是十月三十日星期四。天气很好。我很高兴因为妈妈带我和我的姐姐去菜市。菜市有很多菜和水果，也很多人。菜市很大。妈妈买很多东西。妈妈还买红色的苹果和很多芒果，因为我们都喜欢吃芒果。她也买很多梨。然后她给我买巧克力和我姐姐冰淇淋。最后我们回家后。

Observation: The content is partially irrelevant and incomplete. While there is a clear description of going to the market, the task is not fully fulfilled, as key elements such as getting lost and asking for help are missing. The vocabulary used is appropriate (e.g., 水果、芒果、梨、巧克力等).

Grammar is generally accurate, with minor issues; for example, “最后我们回家后” is an incomplete sentence.

Composition 2 (1 to 2 marks)

今天，妈妈和我去菜市买东西。我们很高兴。今天很多人去菜市。我们吃水果和菜很好了。找不到回家的路。请人帮忙。后来怎么样。

Observation: Very little development, mostly a list of sentences. Does not form a coherent story. Key instructions not followed (no proper ending to “后来怎么样?”). Grammar is very basic and sometimes incorrect: “我们吃水果和菜很好了” unclear. Lacks connectors and narrative flow.

Composition 3 (1 to 2 marks)

一天，我们一起去菜场买青菜和水果。菜市里有在有很多人。找不到回家的路去一会儿朋友。我们请人帮忙去朋友。最后大家回家。

Observation: Weak composition with multiple errors affecting meaning. Meaning is often unclear due to serious grammatical errors, for examples: “菜市里有在有很多人。找不到回家的路去一会儿朋友。我们请人帮忙去朋友。” The story is confusing and poorly organised. The task has been partially addressed. The vocabulary is limited and inaccurately used.

Composition 4 (3 to 5 marks)

今天星期六，李小龙去菜市买菜。菜市里不但有很多人，而且李小龙在菜市里买菜。四十五分后，李小龙要回家。可是他找不到回家的路。他问走路的人帮。一个人决定给李小龙他的手机打电话。李小龙打电话给妈妈问她来了送他。

Observation: Basic narrative with noticeable language errors. The story is partially developed and follows the task (market, many people, lost, asking for help). However, there is repetition (“李小龙在菜市里买菜。”) and awkward sentence construction, such as:

“他问走路的人帮。” The structure is incorrect.

“一个人决定给李小龙他的手机打电话。” The meaning of the sentence is unclear.

“李小龙打电话给妈妈问她来了送他。” The expression used is incorrect. The vocabulary is simple, but mostly appropriate. Organisation is acceptable, but not fluent.

Composition 5 (6 to 8 marks)

今天天气很好，阳光灿烂，我和我的妈妈去菜市买菜。菜市里有很多人。因为我很喜欢吃苹果，所以我的妈妈买了三十个苹果。回家的时候，我们找不到回家的路。妈妈给了爸爸打电话。十分钟以后，爸爸到了。我们坐在爸爸的车。最后我们对爸爸说：“谢谢”。

Observation: A coherent and complete composition with minor errors. Quite well-developed story with clear sequence (going to market, buying, getting lost, solution). Includes all required points. Grammar is mostly correct with a few errors:

“给了爸爸打电话” → should be “给爸爸打电话”

“坐在爸爸的车” → should be “坐在爸爸的车里”

Punctuation issue with “谢谢”. Good use of connectors and details (e.g., 十分钟以后).

Vocabulary is appropriate and slightly varied.

Composition 6 (6 to 8 marks)

今天是星期六，我一个人去菜市买菜。菜市里面有很多的人。我买了很多菜。从上午九点到十点才要回家。突然我找不到回家的路。我请人帮忙打电话给我的妈妈。后来五分钟后妈妈来了。我谢过那个人后就很妈妈回去了。回去后妈妈跟我说下次不要一个人去菜市。

Observation: Well-developed and complete story covering all prompts clearly. Logical sequence and clear narrative flow. Some grammar issues, for examples:

“从上午九点到十点才要回家” → awkward expression

“就很妈妈回去了” → incorrect structure (“跟妈妈回去”)

Good use of time expressions and sequencing. Vocabulary is accurate and appropriate.

The following recommendations may enhance the teaching of Modern Chinese as a foreign language to Mauritian primary school students:

1. Teachers should create a more effective learning environment by adopting blended learning approaches and interactive teaching strategies.
2. Greater emphasis should be placed on vocabulary acquisition, grammar, and their application in sentence construction.
3. Students should be encouraged to develop their listening and speaking skills through active communication in the Chinese language.

Conclusion

Many candidates demonstrated limited foundational knowledge of the Chinese language. In light of this, teachers are encouraged to investigate the underlying causes and adopt appropriate teaching and learning strategies. Such measures are essential to enhance pupils' interest and improve overall performance.